

# Nivya — Team Discussion Brief

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**Document type:** Business + product + engineering overview

**Product:** Nivya — MF-only mutual fund distribution platform (Groww-style UX)

**Business model:** Corporate Mutual Fund Distributor (AMFI ARN) — not SEBI stock broker

**Version:** 1.0

**Date:** 16 June 2026

**Repository:** <https://github.com/Sahil2927/Nivya>

**Disclaimer:** This brief is operational guidance for internal team planning. It is **not legal, tax, or investment advice**. Engage a CA and SEBI/AMFI-experienced compliance counsel before any regulatory filing or public launch.

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## 1. Executive summary

Nivya is intended to launch as a **Corporate Mutual Fund Distributor** in India — distributing **mutual funds only** (lumpsum, SIP, redeem, switch, portfolio) under an **AMFI ARN**, similar to Groww's original MF distribution phase.

**Recommended path: Hybrid (Path B)** — Nivya builds branded web + mobile UX and a BFF (backend-for-frontend); a wealth-tech vendor provides BSE/NSE exchange rails, KYC modules, mandates, and scheme master initially.

**Realistic timeline to public launch:** 5–8 months (hybrid) vs 9–12+ months (full custom exchange build).

**Current engineering state:** MF-only React prototype + mock Fastify BFF + UI wired to /v1 API. Business registrations (ARN, empanelment, vendor) are **not yet complete** — required before real investor money.

## 2. What Nivya is (and is not)

| Nivya IS                                         | Nivya IS NOT (without extra licenses)           |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| AMFI-registered MF distributor                   | SEBI stock broker                               |
| Platform for <b>Regular-plan</b> MF transactions | Equities / F&O trading                          |
| Trail-commission business from AMCs              | Guaranteed-return products                      |
| Discovery + transaction + portfolio app          | Personalized investment advice (needs SEBI RIA) |

### Business flow (Corporate MFD)

#### Retail Investor

- Nivya App/Web (onboarding, discovery, orders)
- KYC (CKYC/KRA)
- Orders tagged with Nivya ARN + employee EUIN
- BSE StAR MF or NSE MF Invest
- RTA (CAMS / KFinTech)
- AMC (unit allotment)
- Trail commission to Nivya (Regular plans only)

### Revenue model

- **Trail commission** from AMCs on Regular-plan AUM (ongoing %).
- **Not permitted:** upfront commission, guaranteed returns, misleading performance claims.

### 3. Current project status

| Item                                         | Status                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| MF-only UI (nivya-app.jsx)                   | ✓ Done — Home, Explore, Portfolio, SIPs, Profile        |
| Vite + React web scaffold                    | ✓ Done                                                  |
| Mock BFF (services/api)                      | ✓ Done — Fastify on port 3001                           |
| UI → BFF integration                         | ✓ Done — Live API badge, schemes/portfolio/SIPs, orders |
| VendorMFAdapter + mock                       | ✓ Done                                                  |
| OpenAPI v0.1, ADR-001, PostgreSQL schema SQL | ✓ Done (schema not wired yet)                           |
| Brand logo                                   | ✓ Done — public/nivya-logo.png                          |
| Company incorporation                        | ✖ Not confirmed                                         |
| NISM V-A / EUIN                              | ✖ Not confirmed                                         |
| Corporate ARN                                | ✖ Placeholder ARN-XXXXXX in demo                        |
| Hybrid vendor signed                         | ✖ Not confirmed                                         |
| AMC empanelment / BSE-NSE production         | ✖ Not started                                           |

#### Run locally (two terminals):

```
npm install
npm run dev:api    # Terminal 1 – http://localhost:3001/v1
npm run dev        # Terminal 2 – http://localhost:5173 (proxies /v1)
```

Demo auth: POST /v1/auth/otp/verify with { "phone": "9876543210", "otp": "123456" }.

### 4. Business checklist — before launch

#### Phase A — Company foundation (Week 1–4)

| #  | Task                                              | Deliverable               | Notes                      |
|----|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------|
| A1 | Incorporate <b>Nivya Pvt Ltd</b> or <b>LLP</b>    | CIN, MOA/AOA, company PAN | ARN issued to legal entity |
| A2 | Open <b>company bank account</b>                  | Current account           | Settlements, vendor fees   |
| A3 | Engage <b>MF compliance counsel</b>               | Retainer agreement        | Review app copy & flows    |
| A4 | Appoint <b>Compliance Officer</b> (fractional OK) | Named CO                  | Ongoing AMFI obligations   |
| A5 | Decide <b>Pvt Ltd vs LLP</b>                      | Written decision          | Governance & fundraising   |

*Can run in parallel with prototype development.*

## Phase B — People certification (Week 2–6)

| #  | Task                              | Deliverable       | Notes                                      |
|----|-----------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| B1 | Enroll for <b>NISM Series V-A</b> | Exam registration | Mandatory for MF distribution              |
| B2 | Pass NISM V-A                     | Certificate       | Prerequisite for EUIN                      |
| B3 | Apply <b>EUIN</b> via CAMS        | EUIN number       | Required on every transaction              |
| B4 | Map EUIN to corporate entity      | Linked employee   | Corporate ARN needs ≥ 1 certified employee |

**Critical rule:** For a **corporate** entity, at least **one employee** must hold valid NISM V-A + EUIN **before** Corporate ARN is allotted.

## Phase C — AMFI registration (Week 3–8)

| #  | Task                                                  | Deliverable                                |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| C1 | Apply for <b>Corporate ARN</b>                        | Application submitted (CAMS/AMFI online)   |
| C2 | Complete <b>KYD</b> (Know Your Distributor)           | Aadhaar-based verification (mandatory)     |
| C3 | Submit required documents                             | DD pack per AMFI                           |
| C4 | Receive <b>ARN certificate</b>                        | Live ARN — replace demo placeholder in app |
| C5 | Annual <b>DSC</b> (Declaration of Self-Certification) | Ongoing AMFI obligation                    |

**Typical documents (verify with counsel / AMFI):** incorporation docs, company PAN, board resolution, NISM certificate, EUIN, KYD, fit & proper declarations for directors.

## Phase D — Policies & compliance (Week 4–10)

| #  | Requirement                                                                                                |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| D1 | <b>Regular plan only</b> policy (initially)                                                                |
| D2 | Display “ <b>AMFI-registered Mutual Fund Distributor</b> ” + <b>ARN</b> on all surfaces (min font size 12) |
| D3 | Show <b>EUIN</b> on transaction confirmations                                                              |
| D4 | Standard MF <b>risk disclaimer</b> on all investment flows                                                 |
| D5 | <b>KIM / SID / SAI</b> access + logged consent before first investment per scheme                          |
| D6 | <b>No personalized investment advice</b> unless separately registered as SEBI RIA                          |
| D7 | <b>DPDP Act</b> privacy policy & data handling                                                             |
| D8 | <b>Grievance redressal</b> + SEBI SCORES escalation path                                                   |
| D9 | Annual AMFI <b>DSC</b> submission                                                                          |

## Phase E — Market access (Week 6–16)

| #  | Task                                                | Purpose                              |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| E1 | <b>Empanel with AMCs</b> (each fund house)          | Place orders + earn trail commission |
| E2 | Register on <b>BSE StAR MF</b>                      | Primary transaction rail             |
| E3 | Register on <b>NSE MF Invest</b> (optional)         | Secondary REST rail                  |
| E4 | Obtain <b>exchange API</b> credentials (UAT → prod) | Engineering integration              |
| E5 | <b>KRA</b> access (CVL, CAMS KRA, etc.)             | Investor KYC                         |
| E6 | <b>Payment gateway + eNACH/OTM</b>                  | Lumpsum + SIP mandates               |
| E7 | Investor <b>bank verification</b>                   | Redemption payouts                   |

**Target:** empanel with **top 10 AMCs** early (HDFC, ICICI, SBI, Nippon, Axis, PPFAS, etc.) — process can take weeks per AMC.

## Phase F — Hybrid vendor (Week 3–12)

| #  | Task                                        | Deliverable                               |
|----|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| F1 | Issue <b>RFP</b> to 3–5 wealth-tech vendors | RFP document                              |
| F2 | Vendor demos + scorecard                    | BSE/NSE, KYC, eNACH, API quality, pricing |
| F3 | <b>Sign hybrid vendor</b> contract / LOI    | Legal agreement                           |
| F4 | Obtain <b>UAT API credentials</b>           | Keys for engineering                      |

**Evaluate vendors on:** BSE StAR MF + NSE MF Invest support, white-label/custom frontend API, KYC module, eNACH/OTM, commission reconciliation, AMC coverage, pricing.

## Phase G — Launch readiness

| #  | Task                                            | When                   |
|----|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| G1 | Customer support (phone + email)                | Before soft launch     |
| G2 | Monthly commission reconciliation with AMCs     | From first live orders |
| G3 | Monitor order success, KYC drop-off, SIP bounce | Soft launch            |
| G4 | Security audit / penetration test               | Before scale           |
| G5 | App Store / Play Store compliance review        | Before mobile launch   |
| G6 | Marketing — <b>no guaranteed returns</b>        | Always                 |

## What you can do now vs must have before real money

| Stage                  | Business minimum                                 | Engineering                                                                                         |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Now (prototype)</b> | Incorporation started, counsel engaged           | UI + mock BFF  |
| <b>Alpha</b>           | NISM + EUIN in progress, vendor shortlisted      | PostgreSQL, OTP login, KYC UI                                                                       |
| <b>UAT beta</b>        | ARN received, vendor UAT keys, 3+ AMCs           | Real sandbox orders                                                                                 |
| <b>Soft launch</b>     | Live ARN in app, grievance live, support trained | 50–200 real users                                                                                   |
| <b>Public launch</b>   | Full empanelment, prod exchange creds            | App stores + marketing                                                                              |

**You cannot accept real retail investments until Phase C + E are largely complete.**

## 5. Regulatory framework (Corporate MFD)

### Governing references

- SEBI Master Circular for Mutual Funds (Jun 27, 2024) — intermediaries
- AMFI Master Circular for Mutual Fund Distributors (Jan 14, 2026)
- AMFI online registration via CAMS portal

### Prohibited / restricted without extra licenses

| Activity                                      | Status                            |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Guaranteed / indicative return schemes        | Prohibited                        |
| Personalized investment advice                | Requires SEBI RIA                 |
| Stock / F&O trading                           | Requires SEBI broker registration |
| Holding client money outside prescribed flows | Prohibited                        |

## 6. Market access & vendor strategy

### Hybrid architecture (accepted — ADR-001)



**Nivya owns:** brand, UX, user data, order orchestration, compliance audit trail.

**Vendor owns (initially):** exchange API maintenance, many AMC integrations, mandates, scheme master.

7. Recommended tech stack

What runs in the repo today

| Layer          | Technology             |
|----------------|------------------------|
| Web UI         | React 19 + Vite 7      |
| Charts / icons | Recharts, Lucide React |
| API client     | src/nivya-api.js       |
| BFF            | Node.js + Fastify 5    |
| Monorepo       | npm workspaces         |
| Compliance     | packages/compliance/   |
| Vendor layer   | services/vendor-mf/    |

Production target

| Layer    | Recommendation                   | Rationale                                 |
|----------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Web      | Next.js (React)                  | SEO for fund discovery; migrate from Vite |
| Mobile   | React Native                     | Same React ecosystem; port from prototype |
| Backend  | Node (Fastify → optional NestJS) | Speed; same language as frontend          |
| Database | PostgreSQL + Redis               | ACID orders; cache sessions/NAV           |
| Queue    | Kafka or AWS SQS                 | Async order status, reconciliation        |
| Infra    | AWS Mumbai / Azure India         | Data residency                            |
| Monorepo | Turborepo                        | apps/web, apps/mobile, shared packages    |

External integrations (via vendor adapter)



| System               | Role                        |
|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| BSE StAR MF          | Primary order rail          |
| NSE MF Invest        | Optional second rail        |
| KRA / CKYC           | Investor KYC                |
| RTA (CAMS, KFinTech) | Folios, holdings, CAS       |
| Razorpay / Cashfree  | Lumpsum payment + eNACH SIP |
| SMS/OTP provider     | Login OTP                   |

## 8. Mobile: Flutter vs React Native

**Important:** React + Vite is **web only**. For Android + iOS App Store apps, choose **React Native** or **Flutter** — not Vite alone.

| Factor              | Flutter               | React + React Native                     |
|---------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Reuse nivya-app.jsx | No — rewrite in Dart  | Partial — same patterns, shared packages |
| Reuse BFF /v1 API   | Yes                   | Yes                                      |
| Web + mobile team   | Often separate stacks | One JS/TS ecosystem                      |
| Aligns with ADR-001 | No                    | <b>Yes</b>                               |
| Time to mobile beta | Slower (UI rewrite)   | Faster (port screens)                    |

**Recommendation for Nivya: React (Vite → Next.js) + React Native** — because the prototype, BFF, and architecture docs are already React/Node.

**Avoid for production MF app:** wrapping the Vite site in WebView/Capacitor as the primary mobile product.

## 9. Engineering roadmap (high level)

| Sprint          | Focus                                                          | Exit criteria                        |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 1 (Weeks 1–2)   | PostgreSQL + wire <code>infra/schema.sql</code>                | State survives API restart           |
| 2 (Weeks 2–4)   | OTP login UI, remove auto demo login                           | Manual login flow                    |
| 3 (Weeks 4–6)   | KYC onboarding + consent/audit log                             | KYC gate before orders               |
| 4 (Weeks 6–8)   | Order status, server-side portfolio updates                    | Full invest/redeem/SIP on mock rails |
| 5 (Weeks 8–14)  | Vendor UAT adapter                                             | Real UAT lumpsum + SIP               |
| 6 (Weeks 10–16) | <code>packages/api-client</code> , Next.js migration, RN shell | Shared SDK + mobile start            |

## 10. Timeline & budget (order of magnitude)

### Timeline

| Approach                    | Time to public launch |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------|
| Full custom exchange build  | 9–12+ months          |
| <b>Hybrid (recommended)</b> | <b>5–8 months</b>     |
| White-label + branding only | 4–6 months            |

### Budget (India, excl. marketing)

| Category                              | Estimate             |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Engineering team (9–12 months)        | ₹80L – ₹2Cr          |
| Compliance, legal, AMFI/exchange fees | ₹10L – ₹30L          |
| Infra, security audit, tools          | ₹15L – ₹40L          |
| <b>Total v1</b>                       | <b>₹1.5Cr – ₹4Cr</b> |

Hybrid vendor path typically reduces engineering cost vs full custom BSE integration.

## 11. 30-day action plan

| Week | Business track                              | Product / tech track            |
|------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 1    | Incorporate company; counsel kickoff        | Finalize hybrid vendor approach |
| 2    | Enroll NISM V-A for key hire                | Monorepo + prototype (✅ done)   |
| 3    | Begin ARN application + KYD                 | PostgreSQL + auth UI            |
| 4    | Vendor RFP + first AMC empanelment contacts | Order persistence + audit log   |

## 12. Decisions required from team

| # | Decision                       | Options                                     | Impact                     |
|---|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1 | Build vs hybrid vs white-label | Hybrid recommended                          | Timeline, cost, UX control |
| 2 | Primary exchange rail          | BSE first vs NSE first                      | Integration priority       |
| 3 | RIA later?                     | Yes / No                                    | Product copy & licensing   |
| 4 | Entity type                    | Pvt Ltd / LLP                               | Governance, fundraising    |
| 5 | Mobile stack                   | <b>React Native</b> (recommended) / Flutter | Hiring, code reuse         |
| 6 | Payment gateway                | Razorpay / Cashfree                         | SIP mandate integration    |
| 7 | Hybrid vendor                  | Shortlist from RFP                          | API access timeline        |

## 13. References & repo map

### Regulatory links

| Resource                                      | URL                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AMFI Master Circular for MFDs (Jan 2026)      | <a href="https://www.amfiindia.com/uploads/AMFI_Master_Circular_for_MF_Ds_3c7f5ee44f.pdf">https://www.amfiindia.com/uploads/AMFI_Master_Circular_for_MF_Ds_3c7f5ee44f.pdf</a>           |
| AMFI — Important Information for Distributors | <a href="https://www.amfiindia.com/distributor-corner/importantinformation_distributors">https://www.amfiindia.com/distributor-corner/importantinformation_distributors</a>             |
| Documents required for distributors           | <a href="https://www.amfiindia.com/Themes/Theme1/downloads/Documentsrequired01-Oct-2024.pdf">https://www.amfiindia.com/Themes/Theme1/downloads/Documentsrequired01-Oct-2024.pdf</a>     |
| FAQs on Distributor Due Diligence             | <a href="https://www.amfiindia.com/Themes/Theme1/downloads/FAQsonDistributorsDueDiligence.pdf">https://www.amfiindia.com/Themes/Theme1/downloads/FAQsonDistributorsDueDiligence.pdf</a> |
| BSE StAR MF                                   | <a href="https://www.bseindia.com/Static/Markets/MutualFunds/BSEStarMF.aspx">https://www.bseindia.com/Static/Markets/MutualFunds/BSEStarMF.aspx</a>                                     |
| NSE MF Invest                                 | <a href="https://www.nseindia.com/static/products-services/about-nmf-getting-on-to">https://www.nseindia.com/static/products-services/about-nmf-getting-on-to</a>                       |

## Repository documents

| File                                | Purpose                            |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| NIVYA-MF-PLATFORM-REPORT.md         | Full strategic & regulatory report |
| HYBRID-E2E-PLAN.md                  | Phase-by-phase execution plan      |
| docs/ADR-001-hybrid-architecture.md | Architecture decision record       |
| docs/openapi.yaml                   | BFF API contract v0.1              |
| infra/schema.sql                    | PostgreSQL schema v0.1             |
| docs/NIVYA-TEAM-DISCUSSION-BRIEF.md | This document                      |

*End of team discussion brief.*

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